

Statement of Belonging

The Korean Culture Club fosters a diverse, inclusive, and equitable environment that celebrates the uniqueness of each individual. We promote diversity, accessibility, collaboration, and accountability for a safe and welcoming space for all.

Solidarity Statement

We recognize that K-Pop would not be the global phenomenon it is today if it were not for Latin American, South Asian, West Asian, African, and Black American cultures. We deeply acknowledge and celebrate the rich diversity within the genre of K-Pop, which embraces cultural influences from around the world. As a cultural organization, it is our utmost responsibility to honor and respect this heritage, in order to foster an environment where cultural harm and appropriation are unequivocally unacceptable. We are committed to refraining from performing or showcasing K-Pop artists who perpetuate and/or reinforce oppressive narratives and acts of cultural appropriation. We stand in solidarity and hold in high esteem the multitude of cultures that have shaped K-Pop into being an international example of cultural appreciation. We are committed to continuous DEI education and advocacy, as well as promoting anti-discrimination while holding ourselves accountable for creating an environment of belonging.

Our Definition of Diversity

Diversity goes beyond visible differences like race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, ability, and age. It includes various backgrounds, experiences, perspectives, and ideologies. Embracing diversity enhances creativity, innovation, and organizational excellence. We value and respect diversity in our community, enabling individuals to thrive and contribute their unique talents and perspectives.

Commitment to Inclusion

We're committed to an inclusive environment where everyone feels valued, respected, and empowered to be authentic. Inclusion goes beyond recognizing differences; it involves actively engaging and understanding diverse experiences. Our goal is a culture of inclusivity that extends to all aspects of our organization, from meetings to community interactions. Through open-mindedness, mutual respect, and active listening, we ensure all voices are heard and valued.

Anti-Discrimination

We reject discrimination, hate, and bigotry in our organization. We stand against any form of bias based on race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, ability, religion, or other characteristics. Our commitment is to create a safe and inclusive space where everyone can participate fully, free from fear of discrimination or prejudice. We understand that addressing discrimination requires ongoing learning, self-reflection, and challenging our own biases and privileges.

Accessibility

Accessibility is central to our organization. We actively support individuals in engaging with our content and activities, ensuring they are accessible to all, regardless of any physical or cognitive disabilities. We provide alternative formats, assistive technologies, and accommodations to ensure equal access to information and opportunities. Your feedback is valuable as we continuously improve our accessibility measures.

Collaborations and Partnerships

Collaboration and partnerships are essential for our belongingness goals. We engage with diverse groups within and outside our community to promote understanding and solidarity. Together, we strive for a more inclusive and equitable society.

Accountability and Evaluation

We are accountable for our actions and impact on the community. Regular self-assessment and evaluation help us improve and track progress towards our belongingness goals. Feedback from members, partners, and faculty is welcomed to enhance our practices and stay committed to belongingness.

This statement of belonging was signed into order on: August 26, 2023 by executive members Elise Harlow, Laya Nedambaram, Dayna Thomas, Alexia Charles, Kayla Moses; the Director for Center for Inclusive Communities, Dr. Franklin Ellis and organization members came together to bring this statement to fruition.